

EDUCATIONAL INNOVATION PORTFOLIO

Curriculum Design • Educational Technology • Assessment • Workflow Automation

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Portfolio at a Glance

I am a university English lecturer, curriculum developer, and educational technology specialist with more than seven years of experience in Chinese higher education. My work focuses on making teaching systems more consistent, classroom-ready, and sustainable through curriculum design, assessment improvement, practical automation, and staff technology support.

120	100–125	700–800	7 + 1
LESSONS REFINED ANNUALLY	STUDENTS TAUGHT EACH SEMESTER	PROGRAMME STUDENTS SUPPORTED	INSTRUCTORS + MANAGER USING ATTENDANCE

Distinctive Contribution

My central contribution is not the use of technology by itself. It is the ability to observe where teachers or students encounter friction, redesign the underlying process, and produce a practical solution that can be used under real classroom conditions.

Qualifications

- Master of Business Administration, University of the People
- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, University of the People
- Cambridge English Level 5 Certificate in Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (CELTA)
- CompTIA Network+
- Google professional certificates in Project Management, Data Analytics, IT Automation with Python, and IT Support

Professional Interests

English for Academic Purposes • curriculum development • educational technology • AI in education • assessment design • learning analytics • programme operations • technology-enhanced learning

1. Design Philosophy

Throughout my career, I have viewed education as a system that can be continuously improved. While teaching remains at the heart of learning, the quality of curriculum, instructional processes, assessment methods, and supporting technology has an equally significant effect on the experience of teachers and students.

Whenever I encounter a process that is inefficient or poorly designed, I instinctively look for ways to improve it. Educational systems should evolve through observation, reflection, testing, and refinement rather than remain static because a process is familiar.

My curriculum design philosophy developed through classroom experience. I observed inconsistent pacing, lessons ending too early, and substantial differences in how complete or usable teaching materials were. Those observations led me to create an eight-stage framework for 80-minute classes and to standardize the supporting teacher guides, answer keys, visual cues, and audio resources around it.

I believe technology should serve education rather than distract from it. I adopt a tool when it solves a genuine instructional or operational problem: reducing repetitive work, making expectations clearer, improving consistency, or giving staff better visibility into what is happening across a programme.

One accomplishment I am especially proud of is creating lessons that require virtually no additional preparation before class. A teacher should be able to open the lesson and begin teaching with the sequence, answer keys, teacher guidance, audio, and student-facing materials already prepared. Reducing teacher workload is not separate from serving students; it allows teachers to devote more attention to interaction and feedback.

Curriculum is never truly finished. Every semester creates new evidence about clarity, pacing, engagement, and usability. Good teaching is not simply about showing up to class. It is about having a well-designed plan that makes students think and learn while giving teachers the tools they need to teach effectively.

2. Project 1 — Eight-Stage Lesson Framework

Role	Curriculum designer and classroom practitioner
Scope	Pre-Intermediate university English lesson set
Status	Implemented and continuously refined
Reach	Approximately 120 lessons per academic year
Core methods	Classroom observation, iterative design, CEFR-aware materials

Overview

The Eight-Stage Lesson Framework is a standardized architecture for 80-minute university English classes. It grew from repeated classroom observation and became the organizing structure for the lesson set I maintain.

Challenge

Early lesson materials varied considerably in pacing, completeness, formatting, and teacher support. Some activities finished before the end of class, forcing teachers to improvise while students were working. Materials also differed in the availability of answer keys, instructions, audio, and visual guidance.

Design Response

I concluded that an 80-minute lesson needed approximately eight stages of about ten minutes each. The framework creates a predictable rhythm among teacher input, student practice, independent work, pair or group interaction, and whole-class feedback. Each stage is supported by teacher guidance and a consistent visual identity.

How It Works

1. Define the lesson outcome and CEFR-appropriate language target.
2. Sequence approximately eight stages to fill the available 80 minutes without rushing or padding.
3. Prepare student-facing activities, teacher guidance, answer keys, visuals, and audio where required.
4. Teach the lesson and observe pacing, instructions, engagement, and student difficulty.
5. Revise the lesson for the next class or semester based on what happened in the classroom.

Operational and Educational Impact

The framework supports approximately 60 lessons per semester and 120 lessons per academic year. It provides teachers with classroom-ready materials and gives students a more predictable instructional flow. Its principal impact is operational and pedagogical consistency; formal comparative learning-outcome data has not yet been collected.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add a one-page eight-stage diagram, two representative lesson screenshots, a before-and-after lesson comparison, and a montage showing the teacher guide, answer key, worksheet, audio cue, and stage illustration. Anonymize all student data.

Reflection

The framework was not produced in a single planning session. It emerged from teaching imperfect materials and correcting them while students worked. That direct feedback loop remains central to how I design curriculum.

Lessons Learned

The best curriculum architecture is specific enough to create consistency but flexible enough to accommodate different language aims and activity types. Classroom observation is the final usability test.

3. Project 2 — Speaking Assessment Platform

Role	Designer, developer, examiner, and maintainer
Scope	Pre-Intermediate one-on-one speaking examinations
Status	Used and reviewed each semester
Reach	Approximately 100–125 assessments personally administered per semester
Technology	HTML, CSS, JavaScript, browser-based delivery

Overview

To improve the consistency and efficiency of individual speaking assessments, I designed a browser-based platform that presents prompts, supports standardized timing, and guides examiners through a consistent sequence without requiring software installation.

Challenge

Speaking assessments are administered individually, with approximately five minutes allocated to each student. Examiners must manage prompts, timing, and sequence while concentrating on student performance. Paper materials add another object to manage and can produce different workflows between examiners.

Design Response

The platform places the required prompts and timed stages into one focused interface. It is intentionally simple so an examiner can begin using it with minimal orientation. Because it runs in a browser, it can be updated between semesters without installing new software on classroom computers.

How It Works

1. Open the assessment in a modern browser.
2. Select or begin the required examination sequence.
3. Present standardized prompts while the interface supports timing and navigation.
4. Keep attention on the student rather than on paper handling or timekeeping.
5. Review the workflow after the assessment period and update it when requirements change.

Operational and Educational Impact

The platform is used by multiple instructors in the Pre-Intermediate team, including the programme manager when he conducts assessments. I use it for approximately 100–125 individual assessments each semester. It reduces examiner distraction and supports a more consistent student experience; it does not replace examiner judgment.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add home-screen and prompt-screen screenshots, a short screen recording, a navigation-flow diagram, and an anonymized demonstration assessment. Include a live link or QR code only after confirming that examination content can be public.

Reflection

Educational technology is most effective when it quietly organizes routine work. The interface succeeds when the examiner can focus on listening to the student rather than thinking about the software.

Lessons Learned

For assessment software, reliability, clarity, and ease of use matter more than feature count. Repeated use under real examination conditions provides the best guidance for improvement.

4. Project 3 — AI-Assisted Curriculum Development

Role	Workflow designer, editor, teacher, and quality reviewer
Scope	Student materials, teacher guidance, visuals, and audio
Status	Embedded in ongoing lesson development
Scale	Supports the refinement of approximately 120 lessons annually
Tools	Generative AI, image generation, ElevenLabs, Microsoft Word

Overview

I developed an AI-assisted curriculum workflow to produce stronger materials at a faster pace while retaining human control over language level, pedagogy, accuracy, and classroom usability. AI is used as a production and drafting tool, not as an authority on what students should learn.

Challenge

Initial AI-generated materials often used vocabulary and sentence structures above the students' CEFR level. The outputs also required substantial formatting, sequencing, answer-key development, and testing before they could be taught. Audio and visual resources were inconsistent or absent.

Design Response

I refined prompts and editing practices to constrain student-facing language, then standardized a production workflow around the eight-stage framework. Each stage can include a customized black-and-white line illustration that acts as a visual anchor. ElevenLabs is used for consistent instructional audio when a lesson requires listening material.

How It Works

1. Define the learning outcome, CEFR range, lesson stage, and required student action.
2. Generate a constrained first draft and check vocabulary, grammar, instructions, and cognitive load.
3. Rewrite or regenerate content that exceeds the target level or does not fit the classroom task.
4. Create the student worksheet, teacher guide, answer key, stage illustration, and audio as needed.
5. Teach the material, observe actual student performance, and revise the source lesson.

Operational and Educational Impact

The workflow makes it possible to maintain a large lesson set without treating first-generation AI output as finished curriculum. The visual and audio conventions have influenced the work of other instructors, several of whom now use the shared ElevenLabs workflow. The most defensible impact is faster production with improved consistency; formal learning-outcome comparisons have not yet been conducted.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add a prompt-to-final-material case study, a before-and-after CEFR adaptation, four representative line illustrations, an audio sample, and a screenshot showing the linked teacher guide and answer key. Confirm licensing before publishing media.

Reflection

AI became valuable only after I learned to reject plausible but unsuitable output. Curriculum quality comes from the teacher's decisions about level, sequencing, context, and revision—not from the speed of generation alone.

Lessons Learned

An effective AI workflow needs explicit quality gates. Faster production is useful only when the resulting materials remain accurate, teachable, level-appropriate, and easy for another instructor to use.

5. Project 4 — Centralized Attendance Tracking

Role	Designer, implementer, and day-to-day support
Scope	English programme attendance across three proficiency levels
Status	Used daily
Reach	Seven instructors, the programme manager, and 700–800 students per semester
Platform	Shared spreadsheet workflow with Microsoft 365 / SharePoint

Overview

I designed a centralized attendance workflow so instructors and the programme manager could work from a shared source rather than isolated personal records. The system turns routine attendance entry into programme-level visibility.

Challenge

Attendance had previously been maintained separately by individual teachers. That approach made records difficult to compare, created inconsistent practices, and limited the manager's ability to identify patterns or intervene with students before the end of a semester.

Design Response

The shared workbook organizes attendance by class and instructor while giving the programme manager a consolidated view. I supported access, classroom-computer setup, and the Microsoft 365 / SharePoint workflow needed for staff to use it consistently.

How It Works

1. Maintain a shared roster and class structure for the semester.
2. Give each instructor access through the programme's shared Microsoft environment.
3. Record attendance during normal daily teaching.
4. Review consolidated records to identify recurring absence or other concerns mid-semester.
5. Update the structure when classes, rosters, or programme requirements change.

Operational and Educational Impact

The attendance system is used daily by seven instructors and the programme manager and supports a programme serving approximately 700–800 students each semester. Its main value is timely visibility: the manager can identify problem patterns during the semester rather than reconstructing them from separate records later.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add a fully anonymized workbook screenshot, a before-and-after workflow diagram, and a short manager-view walkthrough. Remove student names, identification numbers, attendance histories, class codes, and any confidential institutional details.

Reflection

The technical solution was comparatively simple. The difficult and valuable part was moving a team from independent record keeping toward a common habit supported by shared access and daily use.

Lessons Learned

A system creates value when information becomes actionable. Centralization matters because it supports earlier visibility and intervention, not merely because all records occupy one file.

6. Project 5 — Semester Calendar Automation

Role	Designer, AppleScript developer, and distributor
Scope	Semester schedules for teachers and classes
Status	Reused at the beginning of each semester
Adoption	Primary personal workflow with imports used by several colleagues
Technology	AppleScript, spreadsheets / Numbers, Apple Calendar, ICS

Overview

At the beginning of each semester, teaching schedules arrive as spreadsheets. I created an AppleScript workflow that converts those schedules into calendar events and distributable ICS files, eliminating repetitive manual entry.

Challenge

Spreadsheet schedules are readable but do not automatically become usable personal calendars. Manually entering every class, time, room, recurrence, and date introduces unnecessary work and the possibility of transcription errors. Common messaging applications also do not always handle ICS files predictably.

Design Response

The script reads the structured schedule, uses semester-start information to create recurring calendar events, and produces calendars for individual teachers and classes. The resulting ICS files are distributed by email so recipients can open them in their default calendar application.

How It Works

1. Receive the official semester schedule in spreadsheet format.
2. Prepare or open the schedule in the expected structured layout.
3. Run the AppleScript and provide semester-specific date information.
4. Generate calendars and ICS files for the relevant teachers and classes.
5. Distribute the files by email for one-step import into recipients' calendar applications.

Operational and Educational Impact

The workflow removes repeated manual calendar entry for me and has also been imported by several colleagues on their phones. It is reusable each semester with limited adjustment to the source schedule. No formal time study has been completed, so the portfolio describes the eliminated steps rather than claiming an unsupported savings figure.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add an anonymized source-schedule excerpt, a process diagram, an Apple Calendar screenshot, an example ICS event, a short code excerpt, and a 30–60 second screen recording. Remove room or class details if they create security concerns.

Reflection

This project began with a personal annoyance, but it illustrates a broader principle: small recurring tasks are strong automation candidates because their cost and frustration accumulate every semester.

Lessons Learned

A useful automation does not need elegant or complex code. It needs a stable input, a repeatable transformation, and an output that ordinary users can open with tools they already have.

7. Project 6 — Assessment Workflow Modernization

Role	Process advocate, materials editor, and classroom implementer
Scope	Pre-Intermediate objective examinations and revision materials
Status	ZipGrade adopted for the Pre-Intermediate level
Related work	Exam formatting feedback and exam-aligned revision lessons
Tools	ZipGrade, bubble sheets, Microsoft Word, shared digital resources

Overview

I helped modernize assessment operations by advocating for optical mark recognition through ZipGrade, improving exam formatting, and creating revision lessons aligned with programme assessments.

Challenge

Manually marking large numbers of multiple-choice responses consumes teacher time without adding corresponding instructional value. Assessment documents also need clear formatting, answerability, and sufficient review support so students understand the format and language demands before the examination.

Design Response

I encouraged the programme manager to create objective examinations in bubble-sheet format for the Pre-Intermediate team. I also provide formatting feedback on manager-created exams and build review or revision lessons based on the final assessment content. The assessment platform described in Project 2 supports the separate speaking component.

How It Works

1. Review the examination structure and identify items suitable for objective scanning.
2. Format multiple-choice sections for bubble-sheet response capture.
3. Use ZipGrade to scan and calculate objective results.
4. Create classroom revision materials aligned with the examination's language and task types.
5. Collect practical feedback and improve formatting or review materials for the next assessment cycle.

Operational and Educational Impact

ZipGrade is used for Pre-Intermediate objective examinations, reducing the need to mark multiple-choice papers manually. The combined workflow improves operational efficiency while preserving teacher attention for speaking, writing, feedback, and other tasks that require professional judgment. Expansion to other levels should be described only after it is confirmed.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add a redacted bubble sheet, a ZipGrade results-screen mock-up or anonymized screenshot, a sample revision-lesson page, and a process comparison showing manual marking versus scan-and-review. Do not publish live exam questions or student scores.

Reflection

Assessment innovation does not always require a new examination model. Sometimes the highest-value improvement is removing repetitive handling so teachers can spend more time interpreting performance and supporting students.

Lessons Learned

Automation should be applied selectively. Objective responses are well suited to scanning; speaking, writing, and qualitative feedback still require human attention and professional judgment.

8. Project 7 — Digital Enablement and Faculty Support

Role	Peer technology support and workflow enabler
Scope	Classroom computers, shared files, Microsoft accounts, and teaching tools
Status	Ongoing informal contribution
Users	Members of the English teaching team
Environment	Microsoft 365, SharePoint, OneDrive, Authenticator, mixed devices

Overview

Digital systems create programme value only when colleagues can access and use them. Alongside teaching, I provide practical technology support that helps the team open shared files, use classroom computers, and participate in centralized workflows.

Challenge

The teaching environment includes mixed hardware, institutional classroom computers, personal devices, and access restrictions. Some Chinese Android devices make standard Microsoft mobile workflows difficult. Hardware limitations and unfamiliar account procedures can prevent staff from using otherwise useful systems.

Design Response

I help colleagues sign in to Microsoft 365 and SharePoint, configure classroom access, open teaching files, use Microsoft Authenticator, troubleshoot OneDrive, and work around device limitations. When appropriate, I have repurposed available equipment so a colleague can participate in the programme's shared digital workflows.

How It Works

1. Identify the actual access barrier: account, authentication, file permission, device, software, or classroom hardware.
2. Configure the minimum working path to shared teaching resources.
3. Test access on the device and classroom computer the colleague will actually use.
4. Provide practical follow-up when passwords, authentication, syncing, or file formats interrupt the workflow.

5. Use recurring support problems to improve the underlying instructions or system design.

Operational and Educational Impact

This support enabled broader use of shared teaching materials and made programme systems such as centralized attendance more practical. Because it is an informal contribution rather than a formal IT assignment, the portfolio emphasizes the work performed without assigning an unsupported leadership or administrative title.

Evidence planned for the next edition: Add a one-page staff onboarding checklist, a sanitized SharePoint information architecture diagram, and an access-troubleshooting flowchart. Avoid screenshots containing colleague names, account identifiers, institutional URLs, or authentication information.

Reflection

Technology adoption is often harder than technology creation. A technically sound system can still fail if it assumes hardware, accounts, confidence, or support that users do not have.

Lessons Learned

Design for the least convenient real environment, not the ideal demonstration environment. Adoption improves when access is tested on the actual classroom devices and supported through the first points of friction.

9. Programme Impact Summary

The projects in this portfolio form a connected operating system for teaching rather than a collection of isolated tools. Curriculum standardization improves classroom readiness; AI-assisted production expands the capacity to maintain materials; assessment tools remove repetitive handling; attendance creates shared visibility; calendar automation reduces semester setup; and staff support makes the systems usable under real conditions.

Consistency: A repeatable lesson framework, teacher guidance, answer keys, visuals, and audio create a common quality baseline.

Readiness: Teachers can enter class with complete materials instead of rebuilding or repairing lessons immediately before use.

Visibility: Centralized attendance gives the programme manager access to patterns that isolated records could not reveal promptly.

Efficiency: Browser-based assessment, ZipGrade, and calendar automation reduce routine handling and repetitive entry.

Adoption: Account setup, troubleshooting, and practical peer support connect the designed systems to the people expected to use them.

Continuous improvement: Classroom use and semester cycles provide feedback for the next version of each lesson or tool.

Evaluation planned for a future edition: Add evidence that can support stronger outcome claims: teacher-preparation survey, usage logs, attendance intervention examples, assessment-processing time samples, error-rate comparisons, and approved student or colleague feedback. Until then, describe operational reach, not causal learning gains.

10. Future Vision

My next phase of work would connect the existing systems into a clearer evidence loop: curriculum design, student activity, assessment, attendance, and teacher reflection should inform one another without adding unnecessary administrative work. The following ideas are aspirations, not claims about systems already deployed.

AI-assisted formative feedback

Create guided feedback workflows that support teachers while preserving human review and student privacy.

Learning and attendance dashboards

Combine approved, minimal data into early-warning views that help staff identify students needing support.

OCR-assisted written assessment

Use optical character recognition to organize handwritten responses for review without delegating final judgment to automation.

Interactive speaking practice

Create low-stakes browser activities that help students rehearse timed responses before formal one-on-one assessment.

Curriculum quality and version control

Track lesson revisions, evidence, ownership, and classroom feedback so improvement survives staff changes.

LMS and resource integration

Provide a simpler route from curriculum source files to teacher materials, student access, and approved analytics.

Visual planned for a future edition: Create a one-page diagram showing the proposed evidence loop: curriculum → teaching → student activity → assessment and attendance → review → curriculum revision.

11. About and Contact

Wayland Chin is a university English lecturer, curriculum developer, and educational technology specialist from New York City, currently working in Jinhua, Zhejiang, China. He combines university teaching experience with an MBA, a B.S. in Computer Science, CELTA, IT and project-management credentials, and practical experience building systems that improve curriculum, assessment, scheduling, attendance, and staff workflows.

Languages

- English — Native or bilingual proficiency
- Cantonese — Professional working proficiency
- Mandarin — Professional working proficiency

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